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THE NUMBER OF DAYS SKYLAB WAS IN ORBIT AROUND EARTH



THIS YEAR SAW THE LAUNCH

of the USSR's second space station, Salyut 2, in April, while a month later the US launched Skylab. This space station remained in orbit until 1977.

In April, in New York, Motorola researcher Martin Cooper (b.1928) made the first telephone call from a **truly mobile, handheld phone**—albeit one that weighed 2.5lb (1.1 kg). Around the same time, engineers at the European Organization for Nuclear Research (CERN), on the Swiss–French border, were developing the **world's first touch screen**, which was put to use on computers in a sophisticated control room.

Later in the year, American computer scientists **Vint Cerf** (b.1943) and **Robert Kahn** (b.1938) drafted the **internet protocol suite**—a set of networking standards that enable different interconnected computer networks to communicate. The most important components, Transfer Control Protocol and the Internet Protocol (TCP/IP), are the **basis of nearly all traffic across the internet today**. At Xerox's Palo Alto Research Center (PARC) in California, computer

Skylab in orbit

Skylab housed a laboratory, in which astronauts carried out scientific and medical experiments, and carried a telescope for studying the Sun.

Computer touch screen

Danish electronics engineer Bent Stumpe holds one of the first touch screens, which he developed with British engineer Frank Beck.



scientists produced the Alto—the first computer to have a **graphical user interface (GUI) and a mouse**.

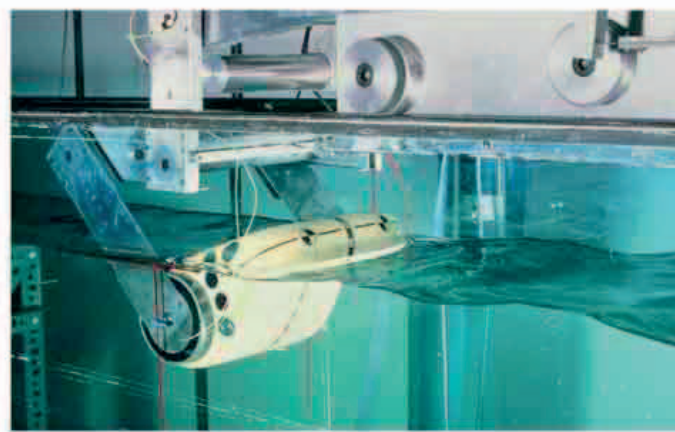
In November, American geneticists Herbert Boyer (b.1936) and Stanley Cohen (b.1935) announced that they had created the **first-ever transgenic organism**, heralding the dawn of genetic engineering. Boyer and Cohen inserted an **antibiotic-resistant gene** from one bacterium into the genome of another, endowing the recipient bacterium with the **donor's resistance** against antibiotics.

Also in November, British inventor Stephen Salter (b.1938) applied for a patent for an

alternative energy device, known as **Salter's duck**, which could **extract energy from water waves**. This device could be used to generate electricity.

Salter's duck

A prototype of the duck generates electric power from waves in a laboratory test. The water behind the duck is flat because its energy has been extracted.



April 3 Launch of USSR's second space station, Salyut 2

April 3 The first mobile telephone call from a handheld mobile phone (cellphone)

May Scientists at CERN invent computer touch screen

May Patent granted for PET (polyethylene terephthalate) plastic bottle, now the most common type

May 14 Launch of NASA's Skylab space station

September American computer scientists Vint Cerf and Robert Kahn produce the first draft of the internet protocol suite

October Xerox's Palo Alto Research Center (PARC) produces first computer to have a graphical user interface (GUI)

October 20 Russian theoretical physicists Volkov and Soroka propose supergravity

November The first transgenic organism created

November 15 British inventor Stephen Salter patents a device to absorb sea-wave energy and convert it into electrical energy